



CULTURAL GEOMETRIES OF THE MANOSPHERE

Exploring language models

trained on manosphere subreddits

using the tried-and-true Word2Vec algorithm

Since the early 2000s, the manosphere has emerged as a network of online communities where men discuss perceived disadvantages in society, relationships and institutions. In these spaces, men spread misogynistic ideologies and often also male supremacist ideas. While often united by the belief that society favors women over men, the manosphere contains diverse and sometimes conflicting narratives about masculinity and men's status.

03 r/MGTOW

Consensual Hallucinations of Gynocentrism in an Interpretive Community within the Manosphere

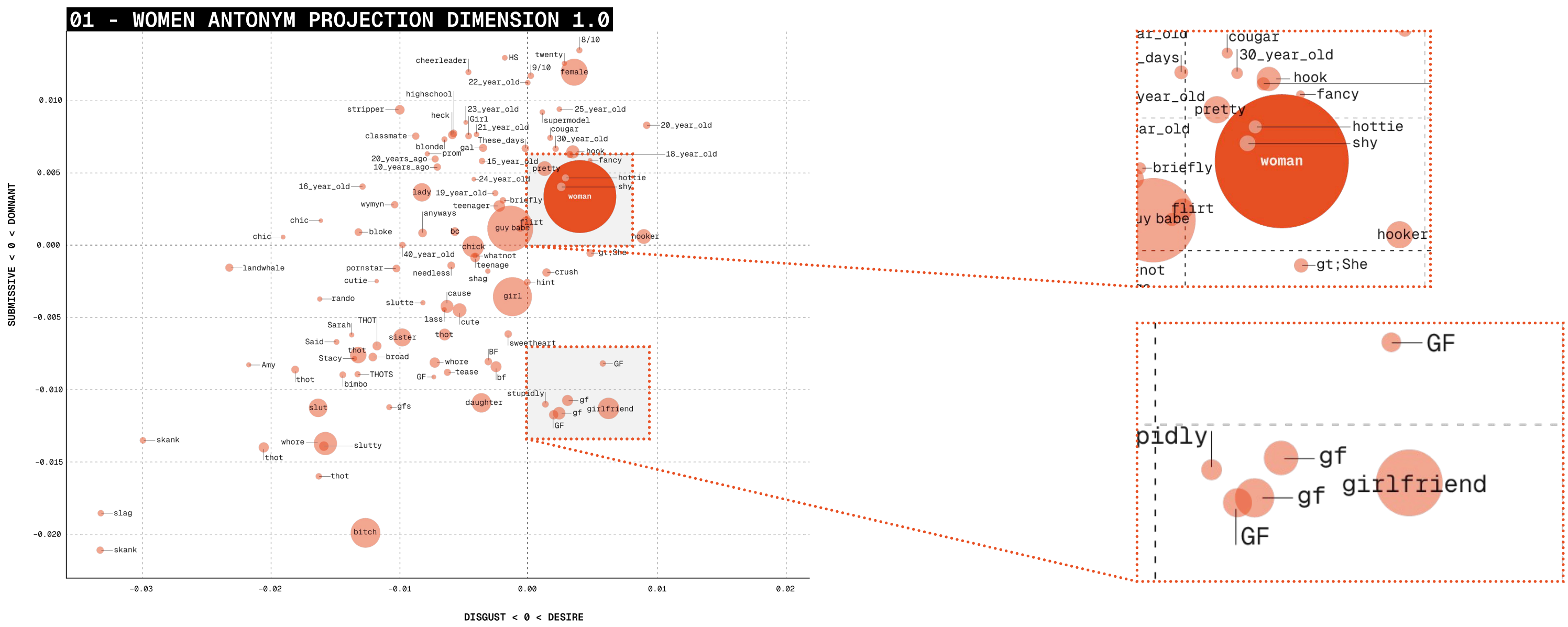
RESEARCH QUESTION

How are heterosexual relations discussed on r/MGTOW and how does this discourse posit women?

FINDING A

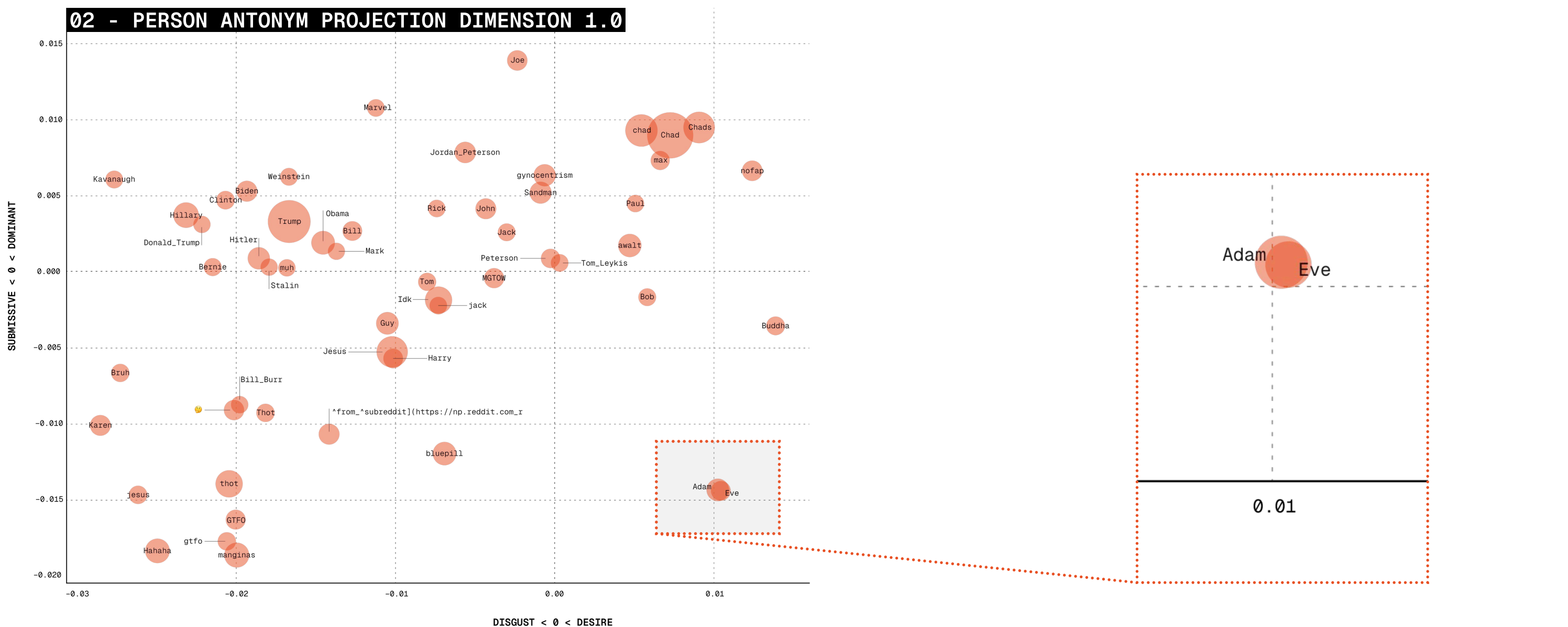
Woman's position in the quadrant is particularly revealing, as it's in dominant-desire. Despite their claimed hatred and disengagement of heterosexual relations, the classification of desirable contradicts this.

Girlfriend and related terms (gf, etc.) are the only significant words found in the submissive-desire quadrant. This contrasts with the positioning of woman, which is in the dominant-desire quadrant. Girlfriend's isolated position suggests women are desirable and submissive when partnered to a man.



FINDING B

Adam and Eve are desirable submissive terms; Eve in the Bible was made from the rib of Adam, who is positioned as a 'simp' in his relation to Eve, following the discourse on women as 'evil' and problematic and Adam as a blind follower.

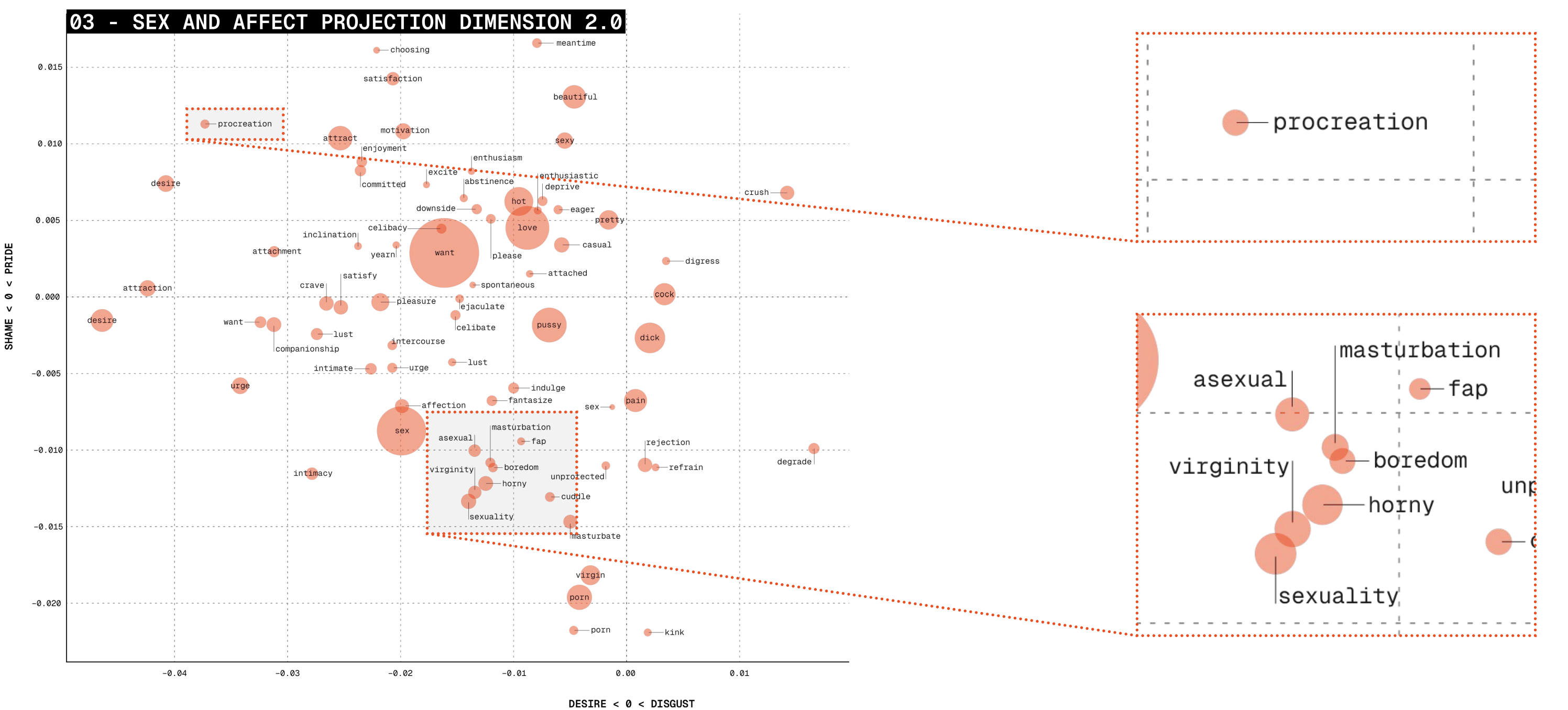


FINDING C

The act of procreation is in the pride-desire quadrant, whereas other terms to describe sexual acts, such as intercourse and sex are classified as shame-desire.

Terms relating to solo sex acts, such as porn and masturbation, are all shameful.

Virgin and virginity are also in the shameful quadrant. Contrarily, abstinence and celibacy are prideful. This suggests that it is not the lack of sex that is shameful, but the lack of agency



METHODOLOGY

A combination of word embedding and concordance analysis was utilized. Revealing words were selected from the frequency distribution file, and related words were found through word embedding. Antonym projections highlighted implicit beliefs, where concordances showed explicit discourse.

To answer the RQ, antonym projections were generated for words related to women, political/ethnic/religious classifiers, and people. These were measured according to dominance vs. submission, and disgust vs. desire. An additional antonym projection was run on words related to affect and sex. These were measured according to disgust vs. desire, and shame vs. pride.

Unexpected and particularly illuminating words in the antonym projection inspired additional concordance analyses to be run. The combination of these methods offered great insight to how heterosexual relations and women are viewed within r/MGTOW.